Daily Content Intel

August 20, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, so a new systematic review pooled 12 video-analysis studies, 538 muscle injuries in professional football, and they went frame by frame through the actual footage to see what was happening at the moment the muscle let go.

Hamstrings were 74.7% of them. Adductors 14.3%. Quads 7.1%, calves 3.9%.

Non-contact injuries outnumbered contact ones about 8 to 1. Meaning the athlete was untouched when it happened.

And here's what they were doing. Running, reaching or stretching out for a ball, and kicking. All of it at moderate to high horizontal speed. Compared to standing still or moving slow, the odds sat around 19 to 1.

Which kind of tracks, right? A hamstring fails when it gets asked to control a fast-moving limb, and the only way to get good at that is to actually go do it.

So here's the Monday change. If your athlete never touches 90% or better of their top speed in practice, their hamstring has never met the thing that's going to hurt it. Build real sprinting into the week, in the offseason and in season, and keep it there when the schedule gets tight.

The authors flagged that the studies were heterogeneous and there's no exposure-adjusted data, so treat the exact numbers as directional. The pattern is pretty clear though.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: A receiver pulled up on a go route with no one within 5 yards of him, and that is the single most common way a hamstring tears.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, so a new systematic review pooled 12 video-analysis studies, 538 muscle injuries in professional football, and they went frame by frame through the actual footage to see what was happening at the moment the muscle let go.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 No one touched him.
- 0:08 538 muscle injuries, studied on video
- 0:14 Hamstring 74.7%
- 0:22 Non-contact beat contact 8 to 1
- 0:34 Running. Reaching. Kicking. At speed.
- 0:41 Odds at speed: roughly 19 to 1

- 0:55 If they never sprint, the hamstring never meets the injury
- 1:12 Directional, not gospel

Caption (copy-paste ready):

12 video-analysis studies, 538 muscle injuries in pro football, reviewed frame by frame.

Hamstrings were 74.7% of them.
Non-contact beat contact roughly 8 to 1, and the injuries clustered at moderate to high horizontal speed while running, reaching, or kicking.

The takeaway I'd give any football or lacrosse athlete: a hamstring that has never been to top speed has never met the thing that tears it. Sprinting is the exposure, and it belongs in the week year round, not just in a summer speed block.

The authors note the studies were heterogeneous with no exposure-adjusted data, so hold the exact numbers loosely. The pattern holds.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
threshold.clientsecure.me

#hamstring #speedtraining #footballtraining #lacrosse #sportsrehab #strengthandconditioning #athletedevelopment #physicaltherapy #returntosport #injuryprevention

Personalize this

- Which of your HS football or club lacrosse athletes actually hits 90% or better of top speed in a normal practice week, and which ones only ever sprint in a summer block? Name the gap you see between the two groups.
- You program HS football. What does your in-season sprint exposure look like on a Tuesday during a game week, and what gets cut first when the coach needs the field?
- Have you had an athlete pull a hamstring untouched, on a route or a clear, and what did their prior 3 weeks of speed exposure actually look like when you went back and checked?

Shoot notes:

- The brief's drop-off clips all show a busy gym background with windows and equipment competing with you. Shoot this one against your cleanest wall, mid-torso up, so the frame has one subject.
- Frame tight enough that your head sits near the top third. Two of the three flagged drop-offs had dead ceiling or wall space filling the upper half.
- First beat is the receiver story, already in motion, full sentence, higher energy than feels natural. No mid-sentence cold open and no wind-up before the claim.

Hook shape: Story hook — "Story hook: 60.9% (-3.2pp vs average, n=4). It survives the scroll better than anything else you open with."

Screenshots:

- title | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42611401/ | "Inciting Events of Lower-Limb Muscle Injury: A Systematic Review and Meta-analysis of Video-Based Studies"

- physiology | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42611401/ | "Hamstring injuries predominated (74.7%), followed by adductor (14.3%), quadriceps (7.1%), and calf (3.9%) injuries."
- actionable | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42611401/ | "lower-limb muscle injuries were predominantly observed during non-contact inciting events occurring at moderate-to-high horizontal speed"

Sources:

- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42611401/
- https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13486463/

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, so this one is fresh off the press. 14 highly trained football players, randomized crossover, the same exact breakfast both times, and the only thing they changed was the order. Carbs first, or carbs last.

Carbs last did what the internet promises it does. Glucose rose less in the first hour, the peak came in about 1.7 millimoles lower, and ghrelin, the hunger hormone, came down.

And then the players turned around and said they were hungrier.

That's the part I keep chewing on. Lower ghrelin, more hunger, more craving for sweet and salty, less satiety. The hormone said one thing and the athlete said another, and when those two disagree, I'm going with the athlete.

So here's my position. The problems I actually see in high school and college athletes are under-fueling, a skipped lunch, 6 hours of sleep, and trying to practice on all of it. A glucose bump after breakfast sits way down that list. Flattening a curve that low on the list, and paying for it by walking around hungrier all morning, is a bad trade.

It's small, right? 14 guys, one meal, and their intake later in the day didn't actually change, so I'm not going to oversell it. There's just nothing in here that earns a spot in an athlete's morning.

Eat the food. All of it. In whatever order gets it in.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: An athlete told me he saves his carbs for last to keep his blood sugar flat, and for an athlete that trade costs more than it pays.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, so this one is fresh off the press. 14 highly trained football players, randomized crossover, the same exact breakfast both times, and the only thing they changed was the order. Carbs first, or carbs last.

Carbs last did what the internet promises it does. Glucose rose less in the first hour, the peak came in about 1.7 millimoles lower, and ghrelin, the hunger hormone, came down.

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It's small, right? 14 guys, one meal, and their intake later in the day didn't actually change, so I'm not going to oversell it. There's just nothing in here that earns a spot in an athlete's morning.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 Carbs last. Flat blood sugar. Worth it?
- 0:10 14 trained footballers, randomized crossover
- 0:20 Peak glucose down ~1.7 mmol/L
- 0:26 Ghrelin down too
- 0:31 And they were hungrier
- 0:45 Under-fueled. Skipped lunch. 6 hours of sleep.
- 0:58 A bad trade for an athlete
- 1:15 Eat the food. All of it.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

A randomized crossover trial fed 14 highly trained football players the same breakfast twice and changed only the order. Carbs last lowered the glucose rise in the first hour and dropped the peak by about 1.7 mmol/L. Ghrelin fell too.

The players still reported more hunger, more craving for sweet and salty, and less satiety.

My read: the things actually limiting high school and college athletes are under-fueling, skipped meals, and short sleep. A breakfast glucose curve sits well below those. Buying a flatter curve with a hungrier morning is a trade I wouldn't make for an athlete.

Small study, 14 players, one meal, and later intake didn't change, so hold it loosely. I'm still comfortable saying the food-order hack has no real place in an athlete's morning.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#sportsnutrition #fuelingforperformance #athletenutrition #footballtraining #lacrosse

#highschoolathlete #strengthandconditioning #physicaltherapy #performancenutrition #undereating

Personalize this

- Which of your athletes have actually brought you a blood-sugar or food-order idea they picked up online, and what were they eating (or skipping) the rest of the day while they worried about it?
- You see under-fueling in HS football and club lacrosse. What does the real breakfast look like for the athletes you're worried about, and what's the first fix you give them?
- Do you have an athlete whose performance or recovery changed once they just ate more, and can you tell that story without naming them?

Shoot notes:

- This one is an opinion, so it lives or dies on energy. The flagged clips are all described as flat expression and low energy. Lean in, talk faster than the research reel, land the last three lines hard.

- Same clean wall as Draft A, but stand a step closer. Keep the top of frame just above your head so there's no empty ceiling.
- Start already mid-thought about the athlete, not mid-sentence about the study. The claim ("that trade costs more than it pays") has to be out of your mouth inside the first 3 seconds.

Hook shape: Story hook — "Story hook: 60.9% (-3.2pp vs average, n=4). It survives the scroll better than anything else you open with." Paired with the brief's "Put the payoff in the first line, not after a wind-up."

Screenshots:

- title | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42617805/ | "Food intake sequence affects postprandial metabolic, hormonal, and appetite responses in healthy male football players: a randomised crossover trial"

- physiology | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42617805/ | "Despite lower ghrelin, participants reported greater mean hunger"
- actionable | https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42617805/ | "a carbohydrate-last meal pattern elicited lower postprandial glycaemia and ghrelin, but greater GIP, triglycerides, hunger, and cravings"

Sources:

- https://pubmed.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/42617805/
- https://clinicaltrials.gov/study/NCT06365385

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Nordic hamstring dose-response, total impulse versus total repetitions (J Sports Sci, PMID 42610665). Blocked today by an eutils rate limit before the abstract could be read. Strong Draft A candidate once verified.
- The lateral jump-landing test with a dual-task component in ACLR athletes at return-to-sport (Phys Ther Sport, PMID 42617458). Good hot take on how quiet and predictable most RTS testing is compared to a live field.
- Creatine from Mike T. Nelson's "Optimal Sprinkles": the loading-phase myth and monohydrate versus the fancy forms. Hold until the "foundation before optimization" framing has cooled off from 2026-08-19.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest newsletter_digest_2026-08-20.pdf, 2 sources. Mercola issue was dental-access commentary plus supplement ads, skipped as promo. Mike T. Nelson's "Optimal Sprinkles" covered creatine with Paul Oneid (no loading phase, monohydrate vs. alternatives, foundation before optimization). Held as a runner-up rather than drafted: yesterday's Draft B was already a Mike T. Nelson "build the base before the fancy molecule" hot take, and running the same argument two days apart would read as a repeat.

- PubMed, date-filtered sweep 2026-08-10 to 2026-08-20 across athlete / return-to-sport / sprint / hamstring / strength-training titles, 58 results reviewed. Surfaced the Sports Medicine Open video-analysis meta-analysis carried into Draft A.
- PubMed, second sweep on youth / adolescent / high-school / football / lacrosse performance and injury, 41 results reviewed. Surfaced the Clinical Nutrition ESPEN food-sequence crossover trial carried into Draft B.
- PubMed article pages returned a cookie wall to the fetcher; abstracts were pulled

through the NCBI eutils API instead. Verbatim screenshot targets are taken from the abstract view per the NCBI source rule.

- NCBI eutils rate-limited on the 4th call, so the Nordic hamstring dose-response paper (PMID 42610665) was not read and is listed as a runner-up rather than cited.
- Generic web search on BJSM / NSCA / youth injury prevention returned mostly undated aggregator content, nothing fresh enough to cite.
- Content brief (Social Media/content-brief.md, generated 2026-08-20T06:25Z), fresh, used for both hooks and both shoot-note blocks.